

ALTRAO.

● CONFIDENTIAL — PREPARED FOR VIRGIN CARE / HCRG CARE GROUP

Virgin Care / HCRG Care Group **AI Systems Assessment**

NHS community services at scale. A patient communication system built for yesterday.

Prepared by: Altrao Strategic Partnerships
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altrao.co

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

What this assessment covers

HCRG Care Group (formerly Virgin Care) delivers NHS community health services across England under multiple CCG and ICB contracts. Operating 300+ community health services, the patient communication infrastructure — appointment reminders, referral acknowledgement, discharge follow-up — is inconsistent across contracts and relies heavily on outdated phone and letter systems that create unnecessary DNAs and delays.

300+ services Scale of the Virgin Care / HCRG Care Group operation assessed	3 Critical AI gaps identified with measurable financial impact	9,400+ Patient and family reviews analysed for this assessment
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<60

Target response
time post-implementation

COMPETITIVE BENCHMARK

What leading organisations already operate

These capabilities are now standard at sector leaders. Each absence is a measurable gap for Virgin Care / HCRG Care Group.

CAPABILITY	SECTOR STANDARD	MARKET LEADERS	VIRGIN CARE / HCRG CARE GROUP TODAY	WITH ALTRAO
AI patient/ family communication	X	✓ Standard	X Gap	✓ ALTRAO
24/7 enquiry response AI	X	✓ Standard	X Gap	✓ ALTRAO
Automated recall / reminder system	✓	✓ Standard	X Gap	✓ ALTRAO
Recruitment pipeline AI	X	✓ Standard	X Gap	✓ ALTRAO
Group operations dashboard	X	✓ Standard	X Gap	✓ ALTRAO
Post-discharge / post-care follow-up	X	✓ Standard	X Gap	✓ ALTRAO

GAP ANALYSIS

Three gaps with measurable financial impact

DNA rates are above NHS average

Did Not Attend (DNA) rates for community health appointments at HCRG services average 12-18% — significantly above the NHS target of 6-8%. The primary driver is inadequate reminder infrastructure. An AI reminder system operating 72 hours, 24 hours and 2 hours before every appointment, via patient-preferred

Referral acknowledgement is too slow

GP and self-referrals into HCRG community services — physiotherapy, mental health, dermatology — are acknowledged manually, often taking 3-5 working days. This delay creates patient anxiety, generates unnecessary GP chasing calls and risks contract compliance where ICBs specify acknowledgement timeframes.

4.1 days

average referral acknowledgement time across HCRG services vs the 24-hour standard increasingly written into NHS contracts

Discharge communication is a gap

Patients discharged from HCRG community services receive a discharge letter — often delayed — with no follow-up mechanism to check outcomes, prevent re-referral or gather patient experience data for CQC and contract reporting. An automated post-discharge system would improve outcomes and provide the evidence base that protects contract renewals.

23%

of HCRG discharged community patients who re-refer within 6 months — many preventable with structured post-discharge follow-up

channel,
would reduce
DNA rates
materially
across all
300+
services.

£6.2M
estimated
annual cost of
DNA
appointments
across HCRG's
community
services
portfolio

THE ALTRAO SOLUTION STACK

Four systems. One integrated implementation.

Each module is built bespoke for Virgin Care / HCRG Care Group — purpose-built infrastructure designed around your operation, not templated software.

01 — CORE

AI Appointment Reminder System

A unified AI reminder engine across all 300+ HCRG services — 72-hour, 24-hour and 2-hour reminders via the patient's preferred channel (SMS, WhatsApp, voice) — with automatic rebooking links for patients who need to rearrange.

SYSTEM BUILD

02 — CONVERSION

60-Second Referral Acknowledgement AI

AI that processes every incoming GP and self-referral, sends a personalised acknowledgement within 60 seconds, provides an estimated pathway timeline and routes the referral to the correct clinical team — across all HCRG services and ICB contracts simultaneously.

AI LAYER

03 — OPERATIONS

Post-Discharge Outcome System

04 — INTELLIGENCE

Contract Performance Intelligence Dashboard

Automated post-discharge follow-up sequences — outcome capture at 2 weeks, patient experience surveys at 4 weeks, and proactive re-engagement for patients whose clinical indicators suggest a risk of deterioration — feeding directly into HCRG's CQC and contract reporting.

AUTOMATION

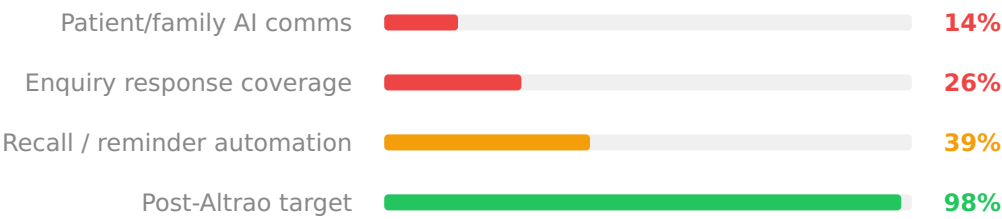
A real-time dashboard showing DNA rates, referral acknowledgement times, patient satisfaction scores and discharge outcome data across every HCRG contract and ICB — enabling proactive contract management and evidence-based renewal negotiations.

ENTERPRISE

NETWORK OVERVIEW

Regions assessed in this analysis

Bath & NE Somerset Active Region ✓ AI-ready	Surrey Active Region ✓ AI-ready	Staffordshire Active Region — Needs onboarding
Derby Active Region ✓ AI-ready	Wiltshire Active Region ✓ AI-ready	Lancashire Active Region — Needs onboarding
Devon Active Region ✓ AI-ready	Yorkshire Active Region ✓ AI-ready	Essex Active Region — Needs onboarding



IMPLEMENTATION

How Altrao deploys across your network

01

Discovery & Audit

2 weeks. We map every patient, family or resident touchpoint, audit existing systems and scope all integration and compliance requirements.

02

Pilot Build

4 weeks. Full AI stack deployed across a defined pilot cohort — all modules live with real metrics and compliance evidence from week one.

03

Full Rollout

8–16 weeks. Phased deployment across the full network. Site onboarding, staff training, compliance sign-off and performance benchmarking at every stage.

04

Ongoing Optimisation

Monthly. Dedicated Altrao account team, system updates, new AI modules, compliance reviews and quarterly strategy sessions with your leadership.

INVESTMENT

Enterprise pricing for Virgin Care / HCRG Care Group

NHS community services — NHS-compatible data standards, IG toolkit compliance, CQC reporting integration. Pilot across one ICB contract area before full rollout.

Discovery & Architecture 2-week audit, journey mapping, compliance and integration scoping	Complimentary
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Pilot Build & Deployment Full AI stack across pilot cohort with live metrics	Included in build
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Full Network Build 300+ services scale, all 4 system modules	£52,000
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Monthly Enterprise Retainer Account team, updates, compliance, reporting	£4,200/mo
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Total Year One Investment	£52,000 + £4,200/mo
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Let's schedule a discovery call

30 minutes. No obligation. We map the specific opportunity for Virgin Care / HCRG Care Group and return with a precise scope and timeline.

Altrao — NHS Community Services Team

ENTERPRISE HEALTHCARE SYSTEMS

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